

MIDISTRUCT V2.0 — Master Studio Edition

User Manual

Developed by Acrosonus Mastering

*ReaScript (Lua) for REAPER — Requires the **ReaImGui** extension*

License: GNU GPL v3

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1. Overview

MIDISTRUCT V2.0 Master Studio Edition is an algorithmic MIDI composition engine for REAPER. It generates complete, full-arrangement MIDI drafts — drums, bass, pad/chords, lead melody, and counter-melody — from nothing more than a chord progression and a set of style and option parameters.

What MIDISTRUCT produces

Every generation creates five colour-coded MIDI tracks in your REAPER project:

Track	Content
[MIDISTRUCT] DRUMS	Kick, snare, hi-hat, ghost notes, fills, crash
[MIDISTRUCT] BASS	Root/fifth/third/seventh bass lines
[MIDISTRUCT] PAD-CHORDS	Voiced chord pads with CC11 swell
[MIDISTRUCT] MELODY	Lead melody with motif/hook system
[MIDISTRUCT] COUNTER-MEL	Counterpoint or call-and-response line

The arrangement spans a full song structure (Intro → Verse → Pre-Chorus → Chorus × 3 → Bridge → Outro) and generates coloured REAPER regions for each section automatically.

2. System Requirements & Installation

Requirements

- **REAPER** 6.x or later (tested on REAPER 7.x)
- **ReaImGui** extension (`reaper.APIExists("ImGui_GetVersion")` must return true)
Install via **ReaPack** → **ReaTeam Extensions** → **js_ReaScriptAPI** bundle

Installation

1. Copy `midistruct_v2_0_master_studio.lua` to your REAPER **Scripts** folder (or any subfolder).
2. In REAPER: **Actions** → **Load ReaScript** → select the file.
3. Optionally assign a keyboard shortcut or toolbar button to the action.

First launch

On first run, if ReaImGui is not installed, MIDISTRUCT shows an error dialog and exits. Install the extension, restart REAPER, and run the script again.

3. Interface Overview

The MIDISTRUCT window (default 620 × 880 px, resizable) is divided into seven collapsible sections plus a central **Generate** button and a read-only report panel.

MIDISTRUCT V2.0 - Master Studio MIDI Composer		
1. Harmony & Chord Progression	▸ [collapses]	
2. Playing Style Hybridization	▸	
3. ★ V2 Musical Humanization & Phrasing	▸	
4. V10.1 Technical & Musical Evolutions	▸	
5. Master Studio Processing (V9/V8)	▸	
6. Groove & Performance Options	▸	
7. General Writing Parameters	▸	
[GENERATE ALGORITHMIC ARRANGEMENT IN REAPER]		
Composition report (read-only)		

All settings are **persisted automatically** between sessions via REAPER's `ExtState` mechanism. Closing the window also triggers a save.

4. Section 1 — Harmony & Chord Progression

This section defines the harmonic material that MIDISTRUCT will use as the foundation for the entire arrangement.

Presets dropdown

A library of 17 ready-made progressions covering common musical contexts:

Category	Examples
Pop	I-V-vi-IV, vi-IV-I-V, I-IV-vi-V, 50s I-vi-IV-V
Minor / Rock	i-VII-VI, i-iv-VII, Andalusian, Rock power i-VII-VI
Jazz / Soul / Neo-Soul	Jazz ii-V-I, Soul Am7 groove, Neo-Soul Dm
Blues	12-bar Blues in A
Electronic	House vi-I-V-IV, Techno i-VI-III-VII

Selecting a preset fills the **Chords** text field automatically. Editing the field manually resets the dropdown to **Manual Entry**.

Chords text field

Enter your own progression using the syntax described in Section 14.

Example:

```
Am:4 F:4 C:4 G:4
```

The engine will loop this progression across all song sections, applying section-specific variations (borrowing, secondary dominants, etc.).

5. Section 2 — Playing Style Hybridization

Primary Style

The main genre template. Seven styles are available:

Style	Default BPM	Swing	Character
Pop	110	12	Bright, tight, A-section focused
Techno (Peak)	133	0	Hard kick, phrygian tension
Lo-Fi Hip Hop	85	35	Lazy groove, pentatonic minor
R&B / Soul	92	28	Dorian, warm pocket
Classic House	124	25	Four-on-the-floor, minor
Trap / Future	140	10	Sparse kick, 808-style
Rock / Alt	120	0	Pentatonic, high energy

Each style carries its own BPM, swing amount, kick/snare pattern, hi-hat ride type, energy level, timing tightness, legato factor, rubato intensity, and modal scale preference.

Secondary Style

An optional second style to blend with the primary. Set to **None (Pure)** for a single-style generation.

Mix Ratio (%)

Only visible when a Secondary Style is selected. At 0% the result is pure Primary; at 100% pure Secondary. Numeric parameters (BPM, swing, energy, etc.) interpolate linearly. Drum patterns and modal choices switch at the 50% threshold.

Example: Primary = Lo-Fi (85 BPM, heavy swing), Secondary = R&B (92 BPM, moderate swing), Mix = 40% → BPM ≈ 88, swing ≈ 30, Lo-Fi drum pattern.

6. Section 3 — V2 Musical Humanization & Phrasing

These are the flagship features introduced in V2.0, controlling how the engine "breathes" and phrases.

Feeling & Interaction

Deterministic Groove (*Constant imperfection vs RNG noise*)

When **on**, timing humanisation uses a fixed push/pull grid with a small Gaussian noise component (25% of normal sigma). The groove "pocket" stays consistent across multiple bars rather than varying randomly.

- Off-beats receive a +18-tick push (scaled by tightness).
- Odd sixteenths receive a +8-tick push.
- 25% Gaussian noise adds organic micro-variation within the pocket.

Use this for machine-tight-yet-alive feels (house, techno, trap). Leave it off for more organic, unpredictable grooves (lo-fi, R&B).

MIDI Sidechain Drums (*Snare ducks Hi-Hat velocity*)

When **on**, hi-hat notes that land on snare steps are written at 55% of their normal velocity, simulating the ducking effect of a compressor sidechain from the snare. Increases intelligibility of the snare crack in dense patterns.

Musicality

Diatonic Bass Approach (*In-scale conjoint movement*)

When **on**, the bass approach note leading into the next chord is chosen as the nearest diatonic (in-key) note rather than the chromatic semitone below/above. Produces cleaner, more classical-sounding bass transitions.

Question & Answer Phrasing (*Tension/Resolution logic*)

When **on**, melodic phrase roles are mapped to harmonic function:

Phrase role	Melodic target
A / B (question)	Scale degree 5 (tension)
A' / A2 (answer)	Scale degree 1 (resolution)

This enforces a call-and-response arc across each four-bar phrase unit.

7. Section 4 — V10.1 Technical & Musical Evolutions

Rhythm & Groove

Euclidean Sequences (*Cyclic polyrhythmic percussions*)

Generates an additional percussive layer (MIDI note 37 — sidestick) using a Bresenham/Euclidean distribution algorithm. The number of hits k is chosen from $\{3, 5, 7\}$ with a random rotation offset, producing cross-rhythmic patterns. Applies to all sections except Intro and Outro.

Organic Groove Maps (*Sub-Step Time-Warping per Style*)

Applies a pre-defined per-style, per-step timing offset table to all MIDI events (drums, bass, pad, melody). Each style has its own micro-timing signature:

Style	Character
Lo-Fi	Wide swings, late 3s and 7s
R&B	Moderate push/pull pattern
Pop	Very subtle, almost straight
Techno	Flat (zero offset)
House	Mild 2s and 6s push
Rock	Slight backbeat drag

This is layered **on top of** individual note humanization and the Deterministic Groove push/pull system.

Bass Octave Jumps (*Disco/Funk slap syncopation*)

At specific bass positions (steps 6, 14, 15), applies a 35% probability of jumping the note up an octave, mimicking slap bass or synth octave pop articulations. Inactive in sparse sections (Intro, Verse, Outro).

Harmony & Melody

Humanized Chord Strumming (*Micro-delays on block chords*)

When **on**, pad chord voicings are not written as simultaneous block chords. Each individual note in the voicing is offset by a random 2–6 tick delay from the previous one, producing the natural spread of a strummed instrument.

Secondary Diminished Chords (*Passing diminished chords*)

Inserts chromatic passing diminished seventh chords between chords whose roots are a whole tone apart (ascending). Probability: 45%. The diminished chord is placed before the target chord and is flagged as a secondary dominant for density calculations.

Strict Counterpoint via Transformation (*Inversion / Retrograde*)

When **on**, the counter-melody in applicable sections (Chorus, Bridge, Verse) is derived from the main melody using classical contrapuntal transformations:

- **Retrograde:** Phrase is mirrored in time (note at step s moves to step $15 - s$).
- **Inversion around the pivot:** Notes are reflected around the scale degree 5 axis.

A 65% probability selects between the two transformations per section.

Timbre & Expression

MPE CC Automations (*CC74 Filter / CC1 Tension curves*)

Writes continuous controller data on the pad track:

- **CC74 (Timbre/Filter):** Written at bar start, value proportional to section dynamic level (range 40–127).
- **CC1 (Modulation/Vibrato):** In Pre-Chorus sections, a rising ramp from 0 to 127 is written step-by-step, creating increasing tension leading to the chorus.

8. Section 5 — Master Studio Processing (V9/V8 Features)

V9 Director Concepts

Physical Groove (*Bass Ghost Notes / Dead Notes*)

Inserts very quiet (velocity ~30), very short (15% of a sixteenth note) ghost notes on the beat before certain bass hits, mimicking dead-note ghost strokes on bass guitar.

Narrative Arc (*Section Macro-Dynamics / Crescendo*)

Applies a section-level dynamic envelope over the course of each section:

- **Intro:** Grows from 60% to 110% of base dynamic (fade in).
- **Outro:** Falls from 110% to 50% (fade out).
- **All others:** Gentle swell from 85% to 115% across the section's bars.

This macro dynamic multiplier scales all velocity values in the section.

Rhythmic Hypnosis (*3-vs-4 Polyrhythmic Pads*)

Replaces the standard pad step grid {0, 4, 8, 12} with {0, 3, 6, 9, 12, 15} (a 6-against-16 cross-rhythm), with each chord duration reduced to 85% of a beat. This creates a hypnotic phasing effect between the pad and the straight drum grid.

V8 Human & Acoustic Algorithms

Optimal Voice Leading (*Keyboardist voice conduction*)

When **on**, pad chord voicings are selected to minimise total voice movement from the previous chord. The engine evaluates all inversions across octaves 4 and 5 and picks the voicing with the smallest sum of absolute interval distances from the preceding voicing.

Temporal Micro-Shift (*Laid-Back snare groove*)

Adds a fixed +16 tick delay to snare hits on beats 2 and 4, producing the characteristic "behind the beat" feel of many soul, R&B, and classic rock recordings.

Metric Velocity Hierarchy

Applies a velocity multiplier based on metric position:

Beat position	Multiplier
Beat 1 (step 0)	×1.15
Beat 3 (step 8)	×1.02
Beats 2 & 4 (steps 4, 12)	×0.94
Off-beats (odd steps)	×0.72
Other even steps	×0.85

Applied independently to melody and bass. Reproduces the natural accent patterns of human performance.

Predictive Modal Interchange

With a 35% probability, the penultimate or final subdominant chord in the progression (root = key + 5 semitones) is borrowed from the parallel minor (changed from major to minor quality). This creates the characteristic "borrowed iv" sound (e.g., F minor in a C major context).

9. Section 6 — Groove & Performance Options (Legacy)

These features were introduced in earlier versions (V8–V9) and remain fully active.

Option	Description
Harmonic Anticipation	Pad chord at step 0 is moved one beat early (–240 ticks) with a compensating duration extension, creating a classic "anticipated" push feel. Probability: 40%.
Melodic Breath (Asphyxia Rule)	After 3 consecutive melody-dense bars, a "breath" bar is generated containing only a single resolution note at step 14. Resets the play streak counter.
Evolving Voicings (Drop 2/3)	In the Chorus, pad voicings use Drop 2 (3rd voice lowered an octave) or Drop 3 (2nd voice lowered) voicing when the chord contains 3 or more notes.
Hi-Hat Groove Pocket	Downbeat hi-hats receive a +10% velocity boost; off-beat hats are reduced by 20%. When a hi-hat coincides with an active kick step, +12 velocity is added.
Fluid Bass Passing Notes	The chromatic approach note (one semitone above/below the next root) is replaced by a diatonically-chosen third of the next chord (probability: 60%).
Pre-Chorus Harmonic Pedal	In Pre-Chorus sections, the bass locks to the global key root for the entire bar on even bars, and adds the approach note only on the final step of odd bars.
Contrary Counterpoint	The counter-melody moves in the opposite direction to the main melody: when the melody ascends, the counter descends, and vice versa.
Melodic Motif Syncopation	The core hook motif's rhythmic positions are shifted ± 1 sixteenth note with a 30% probability per note, creating syncopation within the motif.
Smart Grace Notes	On-beat motif notes (every 4th step) have a 40% chance of receiving a 30-tick grace note (one semitone below, velocity –30) before the main note.
Analog Pitchbend Sag (Synths)	For sustained melody notes (≥ 3 quarter notes) in the second half of a bar (steps 8+), a quadratic pitch-bend fall is applied in the final 40% of the note duration, simulating tape or oscillator drift.
Pitch-Linked Dynamics	Melody note velocity is scaled by its pitch position within the instrument range: higher notes are slightly louder (up to +30% for the highest register).
Beat Drop Silence transition	In the final steps of Pre-Chorus sections, with a 35% probability, all drum hits are suppressed (kick array cleared), and the bass and pad are also muted for steps 12–15, creating a sudden silence before the chorus impact.
Linear Drumming (Realistic Fills & Flams)	Prevents hi-hat and ghost notes from occurring on the same step as snare hits (linear drumming style). Adds flam grace notes (–18 ticks, velocity –40) on beats 2 and 4 with 25% probability.

10. Section 7 — General Writing Parameters

Global Complexity (1–10)

Controls the density of melodic and bass material generated.

- At **1–3**: Sparse, minimal lines with few passing notes.
- At **5–6**: Moderate density, balanced lead melodies.

- At **8–10**: Dense, fast-moving melodic runs, active bass lines.

The complexity value directly multiplies the base note probability in the melody generator: `base_density = 0.13 + complexity × 0.036`.

Random Seed (0 = Random)

MIDISTRUCT uses a deterministic pseudo-random number generator (linear congruential, Lehmer/Park-Miller variant). Entering the same seed with the same settings produces an **identical arrangement** every time.

- **0**: A new random seed is derived from the system clock at each generation.
- **Any positive integer**: Locks the generation to a reproducible result.

The seed used is always reported in the **Composition Report** panel so you can note and recall it.

Replace previous MIDISTRUCT tracks

When **on** (default), all tracks whose name contains `[MIDISTRUCT]` are deleted before generating new ones. Disable this to accumulate multiple generations in the same project for comparison or layering.

11. The Generated Tracks

Track colours

Track	RGB
DRUMS	Red (200, 50, 50)
BASS	Blue (50, 140, 220)
PAD-CHORDS	Purple (140, 60, 220)
MELODY	Green (50, 200, 100)
COUNTER-MEL	Amber (220, 140, 40)

MIDI item layout

Each track is subdivided into one MIDI item per song section (e.g., one item for "Verse", one for "Chorus 1", one for "Chorus 2", etc.). Items are named `[TRACK NAME] | Section Name`. This allows easy muting, copying, or reordering of sections independently.

Drum mapping (General MIDI)

MIDI Note	Instrument
36	Bass Drum (Kick)
37	Side Stick (Euclidean perc)
38	Snare / Ghost / Fill
42	Closed Hi-Hat
46	Open Hi-Hat
49	Crash Cymbal
51	Ride Cymbal (Lo-Fi / Bridge)
53	Ride Bell (Lo-Fi downbeats)

All drum notes are written on **channel 10** (REAPER: channel 10, MIDI byte: 0x99).

CC automation on the Pad track

CC	Purpose
CC11 (Expression)	Exponential attack / linear release swell per chord
CC74 (Timbre)	Filter brightness proportional to section dynamic
CC1 (Modulation)	Pre-Chorus rising tension ramp (with CC Automations option)

Pitch bend on the Melody track

Used for two features:

- **Vibrato:** CC1 ramp (attack → peak → release) on sustained melody notes ≥ 2 quarter-note duration.
- **Analog Sag:** Quadratic pitch-bend fall (8192 → ~7000) in the final 40% of long sustained notes (Analog Pitchbend Sag option).

12. Song Structure & Section Regions

MIDISTRUCT always generates the same structural template, repeating your chord progression through each section:

Section	Bars	Strip Level	Notes
Intro	2× chord loop	2	Sparse — only drums and pad
Verse	2×	0	Full arrangement
Pre-Chorus	1×	0	Rising tension, pre-drop logic
Chorus	2×	0	Full energy, chorus octave boost
Verse	2×	0	Full arrangement
Pre-Chorus	1×	0	
Chorus	2×	0	
Bridge	1×	1	Borrowed chords, modulated
Chorus	2×	0	Third chorus (highest octave)
Outro	1×	2	Very sparse fade

Strip Level controls track density:

- **0:** All five tracks active.
- **1:** Counter-melody suppressed; pads simplified.
- **2:** Only drums and basic pad; melody and bass stripped.

Coloured REAPER **regions** are automatically inserted at each section boundary using section-specific colours:

Section	Colour
Intro	Dark blue
Verse	Dark green
Pre-Chorus	Olive/gold
Chorus	Deep red
Bridge	Purple
Outro	Teal

The tempo marker is also written at the project start using the Primary Style's BPM (or the blended BPM if Style Hybridization is active).

13. Generation Log

After each successful generation, MIDISTRUCT appends an entry to a plain-text log file:

- **Location:** `<Project Folder>/MIDISTRUCT_History.txt`
(Falls back to the REAPER resource folder if no project is saved.)

Each entry records:

- Date and time
- Engine version
- Random seed used
- Key and chord progression
- Style name and final BPM

The log path is shown in the **Composition Report** panel immediately after generation.

14. Chord Syntax Reference

Chords are entered as a space-separated list of tokens:

```
ROOT [QUALITY] [ :DURATION]
```

- **ROOT:** Note name with optional accidental: C, C#, Db, D, D#, Eb, E, F, F#, Gb, G, G#, Ab, A, A#, Bb, B
- **QUALITY:** (optional) chord type suffix — see table below
- **DURATION:** (optional) number of bars this chord lasts; defaults to 4

Supported chord qualities

Suffix	Chord type	Intervals
(none)	Major triad	0-4-7
m or min	Minor triad	0-3-7
7	Dominant 7th	0-4-7-10
maj7	Major 7th	0-4-7-11
m7	Minor 7th	0-3-7-10
9	Dominant 9th	0-4-7-10-14
m9	Minor 9th	0-3-7-10-14
add9	Add9	0-4-7-14
sus4	Suspended 4th	0-5-7
sus2	Suspended 2nd	0-2-7
dim	Diminished triad	0-3-6
dim7	Diminished 7th	0-3-6-9
aug	Augmented triad	0-4-8
5	Power chord	0-7

Examples

C:4 G:4 Am:4 F:4

→ C major I-V-vi-IV (4 bars each)

Dm7:4 G7:4 Cmaj7:4

→ Jazz ii-V-I

Am:2 F:2 C:4 G:4

→ vi-IV two bars, I-V four bars

Bbmaj7:4 Ebmaj7:4 Gm7:4

→ Bb major jazz loop

15. Style Reference

Scale & modal colour per style

Style	Scale	Character
Pop	Major	Bright, resolved, radio-friendly
Lo-Fi Hip Hop	Pentatonic Minor	Dark, nostalgic, simple
R&B / Soul	Dorian	Warm, soulful minor with major 6th
Techno (Peak)	Phrygian	Tense, exotic minor with flat 2
Classic House	Natural Minor (Aeolian)	Dark, flowing
Trap / Future	Natural Minor	Minimal, heavy
Rock / Alt	Pentatonic Minor	Raw, driving

Drum pattern comparison

Style	Kick steps (of 16)	Snare	Swing
Pop	0, 3, 8, 11	4, 12	12
Techno	0, 4, 8, 12 (4-on-floor)	4, 12	0
Lo-Fi	0, 6, 8, 14	4, 12	35
R&B	0, 5, 8, 13	4, 12	28
House	0, 4, 8, 12 (4-on-floor)	4, 12	25
Trap	0, 10, 12	8	10
Rock	0, 4, 8, 12	4, 12	0

16. Advanced Concepts

Key inference

MIDISTRUCT does not require you to specify a key. After parsing the chord progression, the engine votes by pitch-class weight:

1. Each note in every chord's voicing gets 1 vote.
2. Each chord root gets an additional 2 votes.
3. The pitch class with the most votes becomes the inferred root.
4. The presence of a minor third above the root switches between major and minor scale (overriding style default if necessary).

The inferred key and scale are reported in the Composition Report panel.

Hook / Core Motif system

The engine generates one **core motif** per session (seeded deterministically):

- A rhythm pattern (up to 6 attack positions within a 16-step bar)
- A contour pattern of scale-degree movements
- A base octave and starting degree

This motif is stamped on every **A-phrase** (bar 1 of each 4-bar group). Across repetitions, the motif evolves through four variation states:

Variation	Modification
o (original)	Motif as generated
1	Transposed up 2 semitones
2	Raised one octave
3	Raised one octave + added diatonic harmony voice

The chorus forces an additional octave elevation (for all occurrences beyond the first).

Secondary dominant insertion

Between consecutive chord pairs separated by ≥ 3 semitones, the engine optionally inserts:

- A **secondary dominant** (V7 of the next chord root) with 35% probability.
- A **tritone substitution** (when the primary chord is the dominant of the key) with 35% probability.
- A **diminished passing chord** (when chords are a whole-tone apart) with 45% probability (requires the "Secondary Diminished Chords" option).

Bridge borrowing

In the Bridge section, every chord in the progression is **replaced** by a borrowed chord drawn from a set of parallel-mode harmonies (flat VII, flat VI, flat III relative to the current chord root). This ensures the Bridge always provides harmonic contrast regardless of the input progression.

Modulation

The Bridge is generated with a +2 semitone modulation applied to all elements (melody scale, bass roots, pad voicings), simulating a key lift for added energy.

PPQ resolution

MIDISTRUCT uses **240 PPQ** (pulses per quarter note) internally. A 16-step bar equals $16 \times 240 = 3840$ ticks. All timing offsets (swing, humanization, push/pull, organic groove maps) are expressed in ticks at this resolution.

17. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Why do I get an error on launch?

A: The ReaImGui extension is not installed. Install it via ReaPack (ReaTeam Extensions) and restart REAPER.

Q: Can I change the BPM?

A: The BPM is determined by the Primary Style (and blended with the Secondary Style's BPM if applicable). It is written directly to the project tempo at generation time. You can edit it afterwards in REAPER's Tempo Map, but re-generating will overwrite it.

Q: My chord was not recognized. What happened?

A: Check that the root note is spelled correctly (capitalised, with `#` or `b` for accidentals). Qualities must immediately follow the root with no space. The engine shows a dialog if zero valid chords are parsed.

Q: How do I reproduce the same result?

A: Note the seed number in the Composition Report, enter it in the **Random Seed** field, and click Generate again. All other parameters must also be identical.

Q: Can I use MIDISTRUCT on a track that already has content?

A: Yes. If **Replace previous MIDISTRUCT tracks** is off, new `[MIDISTRUCT]` tracks are added alongside existing ones. If it is on, only tracks bearing the `[MIDISTRUCT]` prefix in their name are deleted.

Q: The arrangement always has the same structure. Can I change it?

A: The song structure (Intro → Verse × 2 → etc.) is fixed in V2.0. You can freely delete, rearrange, or loop individual MIDI items after generation.

Q: What is the difference between the "Complexity" slider and the "Energy" property of a style?

A: **Energy** (per-style, 0–1) scales velocity values globally — it controls *how loud* the arrangement is. **Complexity** (1–10) scales melodic *density* — it controls *how many notes* are generated.

Q: Why does the Bass Octave Jumps option not seem to do anything in the Intro?

A: The option is suppressed in sparse sections (Intro, Verse, Outro) where bass lines are already minimal. It activates in Chorus, Pre-Chorus, and active Verse bars.

Q: What does "Strip Level" mean and can I set it manually?

A: Strip Level is automatically assigned by the song structure (0 = full, 1 = no counter-melody, 2 = drums/pad only). It is not a user control; it is part of the arrangement design logic.